Dark Store Placement Intelligence: Delhi-NCR

Strategy brief · where to open the next 10 quick-commerce dark stores

7,521
est. orders / day
(10 new stores)

₹8.6 Cr
est. monthly GMV
(₹380 basket)

7/10
zones in top 10 in
≥80% of weight draws

64
zones eligible
(of 150)

Key findings

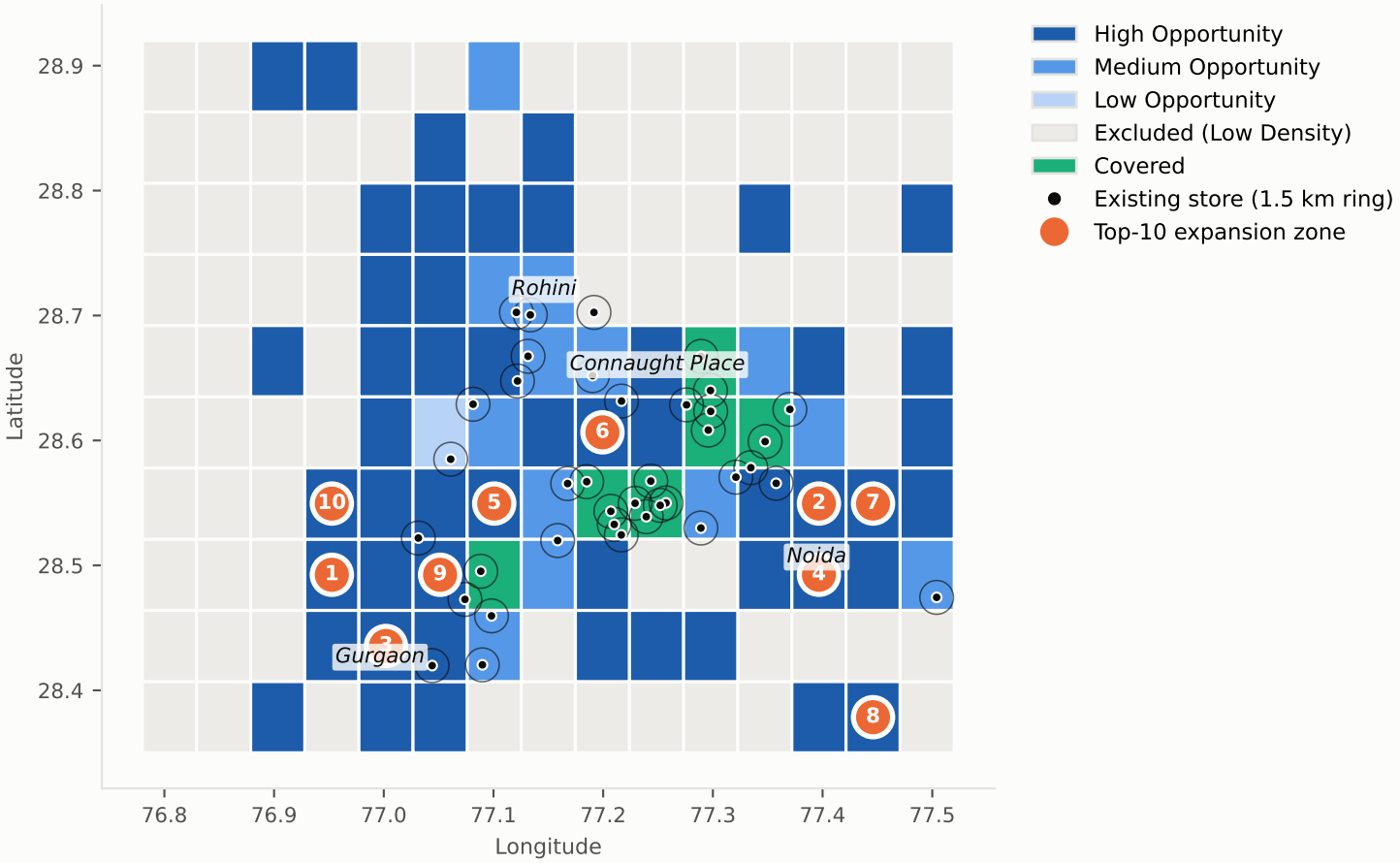
- Of 150 demand zones, 6 sit within 1.5 km of an existing store and 80 fall below the 3,000/km² density floor, leaving 64 candidates; 50 score as High Opportunity (DSOI ≥ 60).
- The top 10 would add ~7,521 orders/day (≈752 per store) and ₹8.6 Cr GMV/month (₹104 Cr/yr) at a ₹380 basket, sizing each store to its 1.5 km catchment, not the whole zone.
- DSOI rank is not order rank: Z069 (densest) leads at 1,509 orders/day while Z049 manages 227; the 35% distance weight lifts remote, affluent but thinner zones.
- 7 of the top 10 stay in the top 10 in ≥80% of 1,000 random weight draws (±~20%); the median draw keeps 9/10. Changing the coverage radius (1-3 km) or density floor (0-4,000/km²) leaves the top 10 unchanged: the ranking is driven by the data, not the thresholds.
- Recommended first wave (robust + highest volume): Z058, Z020, Z043, ~2,776 orders/day, ₹3.2 Cr GMV/month. Validate with real order data before committing capex.

Top 10 expansion zones (one store per zone, 1.5 km catchment) · 'Stable' = share of 1,000 weight draws in top 10

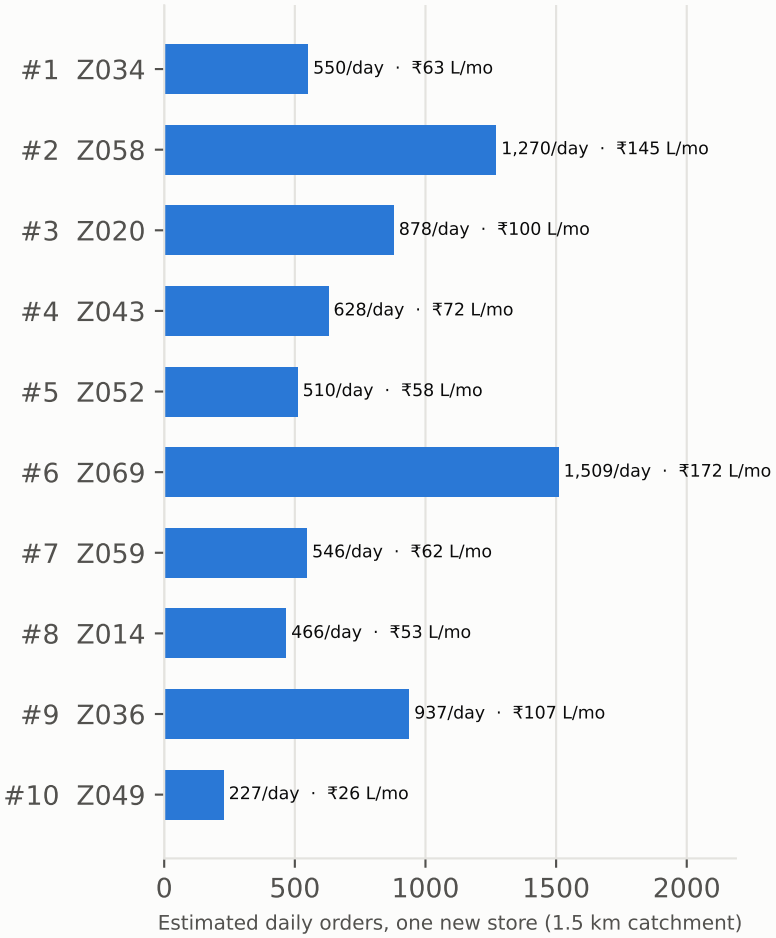
#	Zone	Type	Nearest store	km	Density	DSOI	Orders/day	GMV ₹L/mo	Stable
1	Z034	Urban	Blinkit Palam Vihar	8.4	9,727	100.0	550	63	100%
2	Z058	Metro Core	Zepto Noida Sec 44	4.2	22,451	97.9	1,270	145	95%
3	Z020	Metro Core	Zepto Sohna Road	4.5	15,532	97.1	878	100	99%
4	Z043	Metro Core	Zepto Noida Sec 44	9.0	11,108	91.3	628	72	100%
5	Z052	Urban	Zepto Dwarka Sec 10	5.5	9,026	90.9	510	58	100%
6	Z069	Metro Core	Blinkit Connaught Place	3.2	26,680	90.1	1,509	172	61%
7	Z059	Metro Core	Zepto Noida Sec 44	8.8	9,659	90.0	546	62	96%
8	Z014	Urban	Blinkit Greater Noida	12.1	8,236	88.8	466	53	95%
9	Z036	Metro Core	Blinkit Gurgaon Sec 29	3.1	16,566	88.6	937	107	63%
10	Z049	Urban	Blinkit Palam Vihar	8.3	4,023	86.5	227	26	44%

Data: 38-store seed list of named Blinkit/Zepto/Instamart locations; demand-zone density, income and delivery-demand are synthetic (parametric model calibrated to Delhi-NCR). Methodology demonstration, not a validated site-selection tool. Full method: docs/methodology.md

Where the whitespace is: DSOI tier by demand zone



Orders/day per new store



Rank stability

